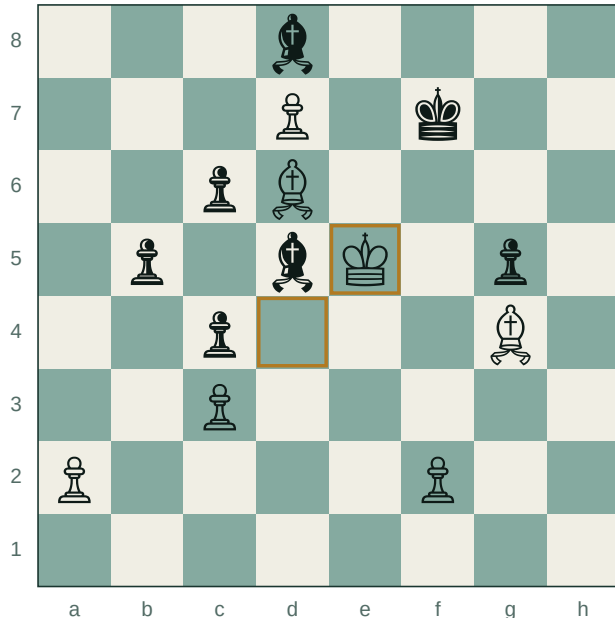


# Bishop-ending decisions: Black, move 47

Bishop-ending decisions

Black to move



Previous move: 47.Ke5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**47...Bf6+ 48. Kf5 Be6+ 49. Ke4 Bxg4**

**47...Bf6+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **48.Kf5**.

**48...Be6+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **49.Ke4**.

**49...Bxg4** The bishop captures the bishop on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on e5. Geometrically undefended: bishop on g4. Check for tactical protection.